PassFrame
TUITION

The Secret Life of Bees

Year 4 — 11+ Mark Scheme (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension · Mark Scheme

For tutor use. Accept any well-reasoned answer supported by evidence from the extract, even if it differs from the wording below.

Lesson Worksheet — Answers

1. Up to 2,000 eggs.

2. Cleaning and guarding the hive, caring for the young, and collecting nectar and pollen.

3. "sometimes travelling over eight kilometres in a single journey."

4. "to tell the other bees exactly where the flowers are and how far away they lie."

5. That the author finds it remarkable or impressive.

6. False — worker bees, which are female, do most of the work.

7. Accept reasoned answers, e.g. a dance can show direction and distance clearly without needing words.

8. It sticks to the hairs on their legs and bodies and is carried to other flowers.

9. Pollination is when pollen is carried between flowers, helping plants produce seeds and fruit; it matters because much of our food depends on it.

10. That bees are extremely important to the food we eat.

11. Accept reasoned answers, e.g. to show readers why bees matter directly to their own lives.

12. Accept a reasoned personal opinion with evidence from the text.

Homework Worksheet — Answers

1. Laying eggs.

2. Nectar and pollen.

3. "Worker bees — all of them female — spend their short lives…"

4. "sometimes travelling over eight kilometres in a single journey."

5. That the bees work constantly without stopping to rest.

6. Correct order: a worker bee finds flowers → a bee performs the waggle dance → pollen sticks to the bee's legs → a plant produces seeds and fruit.

7. Accept reasoned answers, e.g. it reflects how every bee works for the benefit of the whole hive, like a human community.

8. Pollination.

9. Accept reasoned answers, e.g. because it is such a precise and unusual form of communication.

10. That bees are responsible for a very large portion of the food humans eat.

11. "astonishing."

12. Accept any reasoned personal opinion.